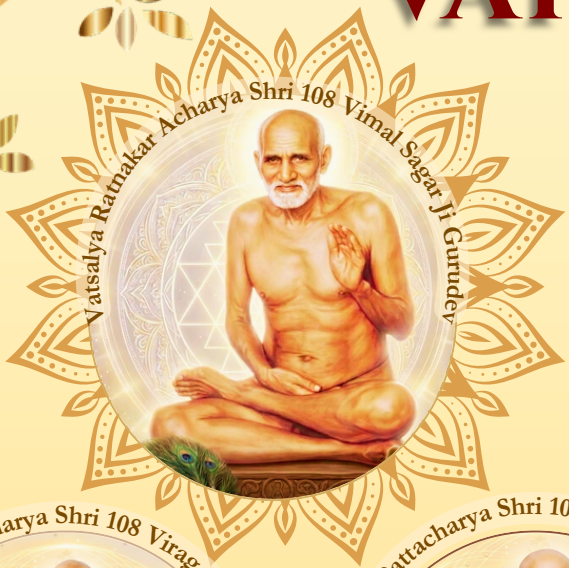
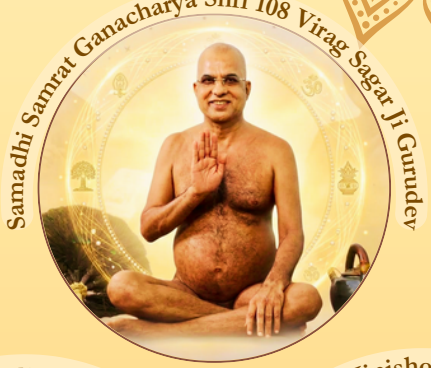
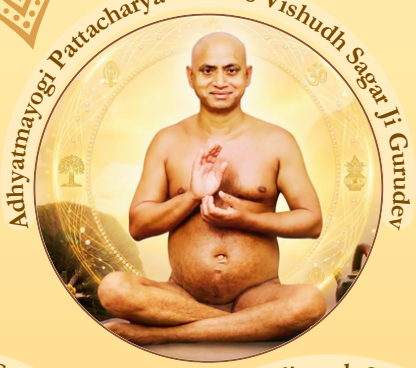
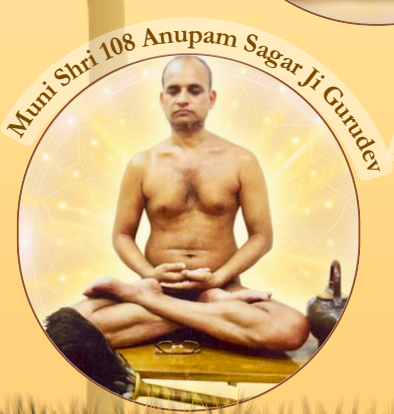
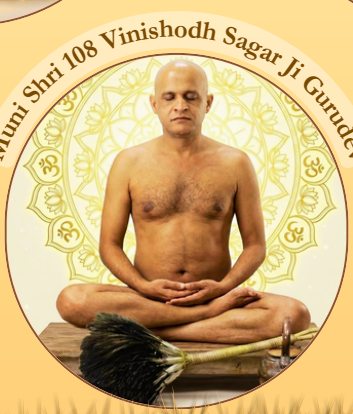
NIRMOH VATIKA

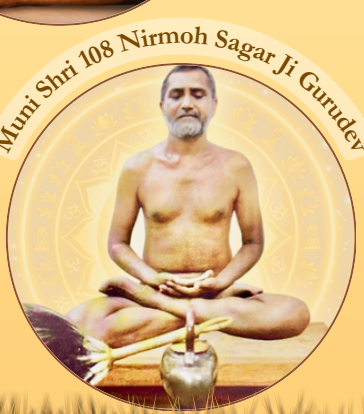












INTRODUCTION

Shramana Muni Shri 108 Nirmoh Sagar Ji Maharaj
was born on 01 January 1975 in Brujpur (District Panna, Madhya Pradesh) as Shri Brijesh Kumar Jain, to deeply religious parents Shri Balchandra Ji Jain and Shrimati Gulab Bai (Gajra Bai) Ji Jain. After completing his basic high school education, he chose the path of giving up worldly attachments, taking the sacred vow of Brahmacharya (a pure life of self-control) in 2016 at Karguan, Jhansi.

Ascending directly to full monastic self-restraint (Siddhi Muni Diksha), he received Muni Diksha on the supreme holy land of Shri Sammed Shikharji Tirth on 14 November 2021 under the divine guidance of Diksha Guru Param Pujya Acharya Shri 108 Vishudh Sagar Ji Maharaj. A native Hindi speaker, his spiritual life is anchored in Vaiyyavratti (selfless service to saints), Deep Dhyaan (contemplation), and continuous Adhyayan (sacred study).

From the Author's Heart

In today's modern world, if we think about how to teach good values to our children, the best way is through Pathshala (religious classes). It is in Pathshala that children learn good habits, religion, morals, and how to connect with society.
Pathshala plays a key role in taking Jainism forward.

Today is the time of smart learning.
To make learning in Pathshala interesting,the "Pathshala : The Learning Program" uses playful activities, knowledge, poems, and stories.

That is why this book focuses on a "look and learn" approach suitable for young children. It will surely help connect children and youth with religion through Pathshalas.

The main inspiration and guide for this book is the Most Respected 108 Muni Shri Nirmoh Sagar Ji Maharaj.

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JAIN DHARMA

Disciple: What is known as Jain Dharma?
Gurudev: The path revealed by the supreme Jinendra is known as Jain Dharma.

Disciple: Who is revered as Jinendra Bhagwan?
Gurudev: One who is termed Vitarag owing to being completely free from attachments, aversions, and other passions ; who is called Sarvagya because He perceives the infinite modes (paryaya) of every substance (dravya); and who is known as Hitopadeshi because He imparts beneficent teachings for the ultimate well-being of all worldly souls (sansari jeev). The Lord in whom all these three divine attributes—Vitarag, Sarvagya, and Hitopadeshi — are fully present is revered as Jinendra Bhagwan.

Disciple: Who founded Jain Dharma?
Gurudev: There is no single founder or initiator of this path. Being existent since time immemorial (Anadikala), it is the eternal path (Shashvat Dharma). In the course of time, its propagation is renewed periodically. In the third and fourth eras of the current descending time cycle , twenty-four Tirthankar Bhagwan manifested. Among them, Bhagwan Rishabhdev was the first Tirthankar, and Bhagwan Vardhaman was the twenty-fourth Tirthankar. The sacred teachings imparted by Bhagwan Vardhaman continue to be preserved and passed down through the holy scriptures to this day.

Disciple: How ancient is Jain Dharma?
Gurudev: Jain Dharma has existed as long as existence itself. The universe had no beginning in time; it has flowed eternally without beginning. Hence, Jain Dharma is also eternal . The nirvaan of its final propagator, Bhagwan Vardhaman, occurred approximately 2530 years ago.

Disciple: According to Bhagwan Vardhaman, what are the core principles of Jain Dharma?

Gurudev: Its core principles are fourfold :

1. Ahinsa (non-injury),
2. Aparigraha (non-possession/non-attachment),
3. Syadvada (the doctrine of conditional predication),
4. Anekantvada (the doctrine of non-absolutism/manifold points of view).

Disciple: Kindly elucidate the distinct characteristics of Jain Philosophy.

Gurudev: Jain philosophy does not regard god as the creator of the universe or existence. In this tradition, there is no entity that creates, preserves, or destroys the cosmos. The universe exists eternally without beginning and shall endure into infinite time.

Disciple: Gurudev, who then created this world? How can the world exist without a creator?

Gurudev: There is no creator of this cosmos. It has been continuing in this very manner eternally from time immemorial. Just as the sun and the moon have eternally risen and set, the six seasons arrive and depart in their appointed order, and flowers blossom and wither—all of this occurs naturally by innate nature . There is no external creator or agent behind it.

PANCH PARMESHTHI

Those who occupy the highest spiritual states and possess the supreme attributes of the soul—before whom earthly kings, emperors, and even celestial Indras bow their heads in devotion—are known as Parmeshthi.

The Parmeshthi are five in number:

1. Arihant, 2. Siddh, 3. Acharya, 4. Upadhyaya, 5. Sadhu .

1. ARIHANT

Those Supreme Souls who have eradicated the four ghaatiya (destructive) karmas, who embody forty-six mulagunas (primary attributes), and who are forever free from the eighteen defects (dosh), are known as Arihant Parmeshthi.

2. SIDDH

Those who have completely destroyed all eight forms of karma, who possess eight fundamental virtues, and who abide eternally in the supreme realm at the summit of the universe (Lok- agrabhag), are known as Siddh Parmeshthi.

3.ACHARYA

The revered monastic leaders who possess thirty-six mulagunas , who serve as the spiritual heads of the holy order (sangh), and who guide their disciples through teaching (shiksha), initiation (diksha), penance (prayascitta), and discourse on the sacred Law (dharmopadesh), are known as Acharya Parmeshthi.

4.UPADHYAYA

The venerable ascetics who reside within the sangh to lead and instruct fellow disciples in the study of the sacred scriptures, and who possess twenty-five mulagunas, are known as Upadhyaya Parmeshthi.

5. SADHU

Those holy ascetics who remain deeply absorbed in self-knowledge (gyaan), meditation (dhyaan), and austerities (tapa), who are completely detached from worldly occupations (arambha) and possessions (parigraha), and who embody twenty-eight mulagunas, are known as Sadhu Parmeshthi.

THE 3 EMBLEMS OF JAINS

Through great good fortune, we have attained a noble birth and the sacred path of Jain Dharma. Therefore, it is our duty to align our conduct, dietary habits, and daily life in accordance with Dharma. For this purpose, paying heed to three primary observances is of utmost importance:

1. DEV DARSHAN (VENERATING THE SUPREME BEING)

We ought to unfailingly pay our homage (Darshan) to the revered Shri Jinendra Bhagwan every morning. The prescribed method is as follows: Upon awakening in the morning, one should prayerfully recollect the sacred Namokar Mantra. Thereafter, after performing daily purification routines such as cleansing and bathing, one should wear pure garments.
Holding offerings (samagri) with reverence and taking care to protect all living beings (jeev-jantu) along the way, one should proceed to the Jin temple.

Before entering the temple, remove footwear outside, wash hands and feet with water, and while chanting the praises of the Lord, utter "Nihsahi, Nihsahi, Nihsahi" three times to renounce worldly thoughts. Subsequently, while softly reciting "Om, Jay, Jay, Jay, Namostu, Namostu, Namostu, offer the eight sacred substances (Asht dravya) or unbroken rice grains (Akshat). Thereafter, chant the Namokar Mantra and offer prostrations (dhok). Following this, recite the glory of the Namokar Mantra (Eso panch namoyaro..) along with the names of the 24 Tirthankaras. Then, while chanting sacred hymns of praise such as Prabhu Patit Pavan, perform three circumambulations (pradakshina) around the Lord.

While circumambulating, keep one's gaze reverently towards the Lord from all directions and bow down. Afterwards, bow in prostration once more and apply the sacred wash of the deity (Gandhodak) while reciting this mantra:

Nirmalam Nirmalikarnam , Pavitram Paap Naashnam
Jin gandhodakam vande , Asht karma vinashnam .

(I bow to the pure and purifying Jinendra Gandhodak, which destroys all sins and obliterates the eight karmas.)

Thereafter, after chanting the Namokar Mantra nine times, one must read, with devotion ,the sacred scriptures (Shastra) kept within the temple premises. If time permits, chant one rosary cycle (mala) of the Namokar Mantra, and exit the temple respectfully without ever turning one's back towards the revered Lord.

Note:

1. One must not enter the Mandir ji (temple) wearing impure items such as leather.
2. One should not enter the Mandir ji with an unwashed mouth.
3. One must enter the Mandir ji only after washing one's hands and feet.
4. While partaking in Darshan in the Mandir ji, one should continuously gaze upon the idol of the Bhagwan . One should not look elsewhere, nor engage in conversation with anyone.

2. RATRI BHOJAN TYAAG (RENUNCIATION OF NIGHT DINING)

To protect living beings (jeev) is our paramount duty (dharma). During the day, the rays of the sun prevent the generation of minute organisms. As we observe, as soon as the sun sets during the rainy season, insects gather around electric bulbs, whereas they do not appear during daylight. This proves that the manifestation of living beings during the daytime is negligible or non-existent. Therefore, we ought to prepare and consume our meals only during the day. Partaking in food at night incurs a spiritual transgression (dosh) akin to meat-consumption. Sleeping after dining at night impairs digestion, which leads to the manifestation of various afflictions. Furthermore, while dining at night, there is an absence of the sun's ultraviolet rays, depriving us of the full benefits of Vitamin D. Hence, meals must be taken strictly during daylight hours.

3. PANI CHHAN-KAR PEENA (DRINKING STRAINED WATER)

The venerated Jain Acharyas have taught that innumerable living beings (jeev) reside within a single drop of water. Consuming unstrained water causes harm to these beings and adversely affects health. Scientists too have indicated the presence of 36,450 organisms in a single drop of un-filtered water. Therefore, one should always consume water only after straining it. For filtering water, a double-layered thick cloth filter should be used—thick enough that sunlight cannot pass through it. Filtered water remains free of trasa jeevas (mobile living beings) for up to 48 minutes; thereafter, trasa jeevas begin to regenerate in it, so it must be strained again.

24 TIRTHANKARAS

1] RISHABHDEV(ADINATH) JI
SYMBOL - BULL

5] SUMATINATH JI
SYMBOL - CURLEW

9] PUSHPDANT JI
SYMBOL - CROCODILE

2] AJITNATH JI
SYMBOL - ELEPHANT

6] PADMAPRABHU JI
SYMBOL - LOTUS

10] SHEETALNATH JI
SYMBOL - KALPAVRAKSH
(WISHING TREE)

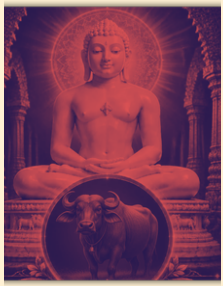
3] SAMBHAVNATH JI
SYMBOL - HORSE

7] SUPARSHVANATH JI
SYMBOL - SWASTIK

11] SHREYANSHNATH JI
SYMBOL - RHINOCEROS

4] ABHINANDAN JI
SYMBOL - MONKEY

8] CHANDRAPRABHU JI
SYMBOL - MOON



12] VASUPUJYA JI
SYMBOL - BUFFALO

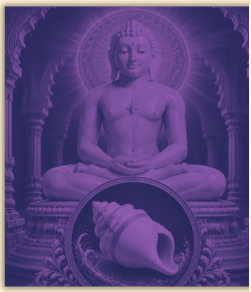
13] VIMALNATH JI
SYMBOL - PIG

17] KUNTHUNATH JI
SYMBOL - GOAT

21] NAMINATH JI
SYMBOL - BLUE LOTUS

14] ANANTNATH JI
SYMBOL - PORCUPINE

18] ARANATH JI
SYMBOL - FISH



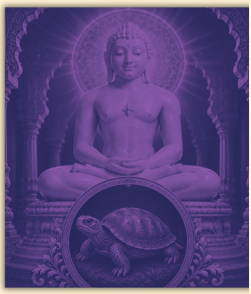
22] NEMINATH JI
SYMBOL - CONCH

15] DHARMANATH JI
SYMBOL - VAJRA

19] MALLINATH JI
SYMBOL - KALASH

23] PARSHVANATH JI
SYMBOL - SNAKE

16] SHANTINATH JI
SYMBOL - DEER



20] MUNISUVRATNATH JI
SYMBOL - TORTOISE

24] MAHAVIR(VARDHMAN)JI
SYMBOL - LION

(VERSE OF SACRED NAMES)

Rishabh Ajit Sambhav Abhinandan
Sumati Padma Suparshva Jinraay
(O King of Jinas)!
Chandraprabhu Pushpdant Sheetal Shreyansh -Jina ,
Vasupujya Poojit Suraraya!
(worshipped by the king of celestial beings).
Vimal Anant Dharma Jas ujjwal,
(of radiant glory),
Shanti Kunthu Ara Malli manay (revered)!
Munisuvrat Nami Nemi Parshva prabhu ,
Vardhman pad sheesh nawaay!
(Before the feet of Vardhman, I humbly bow my head).

(VERSE OF DIVINE COMPLEXIONS)

Two are Fair-complexioned , Two Dark ,
Two Emerald-Green , Two Red .
Sixteen shine with the brilliance of pure
Gold ; unto them, I offer my humble
obeisance across all three realms of time
(Trikala).

(COMPLEXION DETAILS)

Chandraprabhu and Pushpadant – White Complexion (Shwetvarna)
Munisuvratnath and Neminath – Dark Complexion (Shyamvarna)
Padmaprabhu and Vasupujya – Red Complexion (Raktvarna)
Suparshvanath and Parshvanath – Green Complexion (Haritvarna)
The Remaining Sixteen Tirthankar – Golden-Yellow Complexion

JEEV - AJEEV

Jeev: That which knows, beholds, and experiences joy and sorrow is known as jeev (the conscious soul).

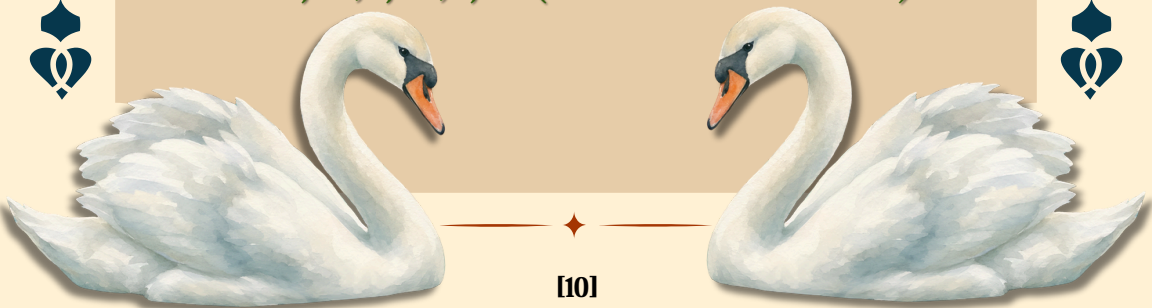
Jeev: I am jeev
Knowledge resides within me.
It is through knowledge that I know.

Ajeev : That which neither knows, nor beholds, nor experiences joy or sorrow is known as ajeev (non-conscious substance).

Ajeev: The physical body is ajeev.
It lacks knowledge.
It knows nothing at all.

SELF-REFLECTION ON JEEV AND AJEEV

Tell me, who are you?
— Jeev , Jeev , Jeev (I am the living soul).
What resides within you?
— Gyaan, Gyaan, Gyaan (pure, knowing awareness).
What do you do through this knowledge?
— We know, we know, we know.
Tell me, what is the body?
—Ajeev,Ajeev,Ajeev (devoid of consciousness).



THE NATURE & REASON OF JEEV AND AJEEV

Tell me, what is this?

~Jeev...Jeev...Jeev...
(The living soul)

Why...?Why...?Why...?

~Because it possesses awareness - it knows,beholds & experiences joy and sorrow.

Tell me,what is this?

~Ajeev...Ajeev...Ajeev...
(Inert non-soul)

Why...?Why...?Why...?

~Because it lacks consciousness - it neither knows,nor beholds,nor experiences joy or sorrow

Compassion (Daya)

Monkeys, dogs, snakes, or cats; sparrows, pigeons, parrots, and birds.
Flies, mosquitoes, and wasps;
goats, buffaloes, hens, or cows.

Bound by the effects of past karma, all living beings wander about full of fear and distress.
May we never torment any soul;
let us remain mindful and protect them always.

RESOLUTIONS OF THE SOUL

I Shall Attain Pure Perfection
(Siddh Banunga)
I shall attain the state of Siddh Bhagwan
(the supreme liberated soul).
I shall ascend to Siddhalaya
(the realm of liberated souls).
Through the practice of my true innate nature,
I shall attain supreme eternal bliss.

MY INNER KNOWLEDGE
(MERA GYAAN)

Behold the sacred light of my
inner knowledge (Gyaan);
may it remain eternally with me.
Opening the inner eyes unto all existence,
I realize that the soul alone is my true home.

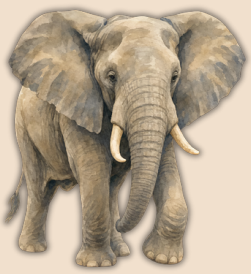
JEEV

LORD

MUNIRAJ

TREE

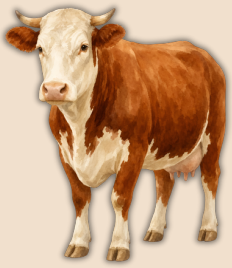
BUTTERFLY



ELEPHANT

EGGS

BIRDS



COW

FLOWERS

PENGUIN

DOG

SPIDER

PLANT

LION

CAT

KIDS

AJEEV

BOOK

MALA

TOMATO

WATCH

CUSHION

LAPTOP

ONION

BOTTLE

RING

BLANKET

BED

AIR CONDITIONER

BAG

BALL

SHIP

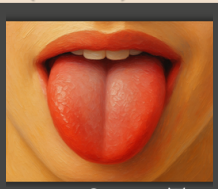
MOUNTAINS

BUILDING

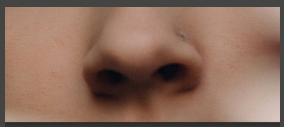
(Indriya - Senses)

The distinguishing signs by which a worldly soul is recognized are termed as Indriyas (senses). There are five indriyas:

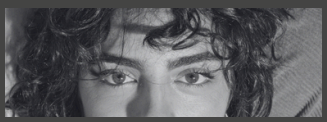
Tactile Sense (Touch)



Gustatory Sense (Taste)



Olfactory Sense (Smell)



Visual Sense (Sight)

Auditory Sense (Hearing)

Objects of the Senses

[3] Smell

Pleasant fragrance

Unpleasant odor

[4] Sight

Black

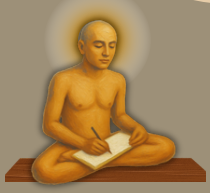
White

Red

Blue

Yellow

[5] Hearing



Listening reverently to the sacred discourses of holy Muniraj

Listening to spiritual & righteous discourses (Dharma Charcha)

Listening to sacred hymns & devotional chants

Listening attentively to the wise words of elders / grandmother

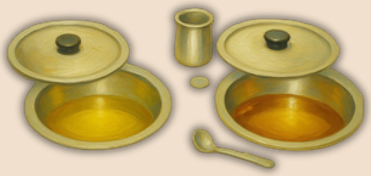
Listening to useful & purposeful dialogue

SACRED ITEMS OF THE TEMPLE

GANDHODAK MANTRA

Nirmalam Nirmalikarnam , Pavitram Paap Naashnam
Jin gandhodakam vande , Asht karma vinashnam .

(Pure, bestower of purity, sacred, and the destroyer of all sins.
I bow reverently to the Gandhodak of the Jina,
which annihilates the eight karmic bonds).



ASHT MANGAL (EIGHT AUSPICIOUS SYMBOLS)

Darpan(Mirror), Kalash (Sacred Pitcher),
Dhwaja(Flag), and Thona(Auspicious Base),
Chatra (Parasol), Chamar (Fly-whisk),
Jhari (Spouted Vessel), and Bijana(Hand Fan).

These eight auspicious substances (Asht Mangal Dravya)
enhance the divine grandeur alongside the idol of the Lord (Jina Pratima).

ASHT PRATIHARYA (EIGHT DIVINE ATTRIBUTES)

Seated beneath the Ashoka tree upon the sacred throne,
Adorned with the three umbrellas (Chatra), shines the Supreme Jinendra.
Brightened by the halo (Bhamandal), gently fanned by Chamar ,
A shower of divine flowers and the celestial drum (Dundubhi) enchant the mind.
Encompassing all languages, the sacred divine voice (Divyadhwani) flows,
Illuminating the path of liberation for all worthy souls .
Beholding the Lord, endowed with these eight divine attributes (Pratiharya),
The worthy souls sway in bliss within the sacred assembly (Samavasaran).

THE TEMPLE BELL

Tan-tan-tan... rings the bell in the sacred temple...
We shall journey to the temple and perform devotions (Pooja);
We shall perform devotions and engage in sacred study (Swadhyaya).
Who among us? You, me, and all of us...

We shall journey to the temple and perform worship;
We shall bring along our father, and bring along our mother.
Who among us? You, me, and all of us...

We shall journey to the temple and engage in sacred study (Swadhyaya);
We shall bring along our grandfather, and bring along our grandmother.
Who among us? You, me, and all of us...

We shall journey to the temple and immerse in devotion (Bhakti);
We shall bring along our brother, and bring along our sister-in-law.
Who among us? You, me, and all of us...

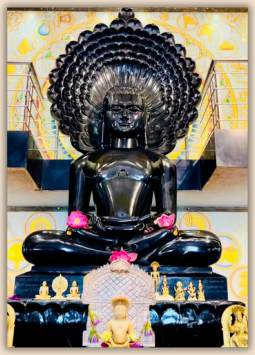
THE SAFFRON FLAG

How unique, how beloved is this sacred flag!
A flag that brings joyous bliss to all of us.
The saffron flag, the sacred saffron flag,
A flag that dispels all sorrow and suffering.
Adorned with the sacred Swastik emblem,
The beloved flag of Lord Mahavir (Veer Prabhu),
A flag held dear by the revered ascetics (Muniraj),
A flag upheld and honored by the learned scholars (Vidvan).
We shall go to the garden of inner consciousness (Chetan baag),
Where we shall hoist this sacred flag high,

And together in unity, we shall proclaim:

Jainam Jayatu Shasnam(May the Jain Order prevail in eternal glory!)
Jainam Jayatu Shasnam(May the Jain Order prevail in eternal glory!)

SACRED UTENSILS & OBJECTS OF THE TEMPLE



JINA PRATIMA

(an embodiment of absolute detachment, free from all worldly attachment & aversion).

VEDI

(the sacred altar is the holy platform where the statue of the Jinendra Dev is placed).

SINHASAN

(the exalted seat upon which the supreme lord reside).

YANTRA JI

(A sacred diagram that brings good fortune and positive energy).

JINVANI

(The sacred teachings of the Enlightened Ones that guide us toward peace and non-attachment).

ABHISHEK KALASH

(The holy water pots used for performing the ceremonial bath (Abhishek) of the Lord).

DAANPATRA

(The donation box used for giving quiet, selfless charity).

GHANTA

(The temple bell, rung as a sign of purity and devotion).

GANDHODAK PATRA

(The bowl that holds the fragrant, holy water blessed by the Lord's ceremony)

CHAMAR

(Sacred whisk-fans waved with love and devotion while worshipping the Lord).

JAPMALA

(The prayer beads used for chanting holy mantras like the Namokar Mantra).

CHAUKI

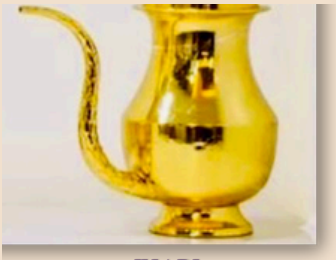
(A low wooden table used to place the prayer tray or holy books (Jinvani).

CHATRA

(The three-tiered royal umbrella symbolizing the Lord's supremacy over the three worlds).

PANDUKSHILA

(A sacred rock platform replica used for performing the ceremonial bath (Abhishek) of the Lord).



JHARI

(A sacred spouted pot used in rituals, one of the eight auspicious symbols (Asht Mangala).

PANKHA

(A sacred hand-fan, one of the eight auspicious symbols).

SWASTIK

(The holy symbol representing the four realms of worldly rebirth).

DHWAJA

(The holy Jain flag hoisted at the top of the temple spire (Shikhar).

KALASH

(A sacred holy pot symbolizing purity and auspiciousness).

POOJAN THALI

(The worship tray used to hold the eight sacred offerings (Asht Dravya).

DARPAN

(The sacred mirror, one of the eight auspicious symbols representing self-reflection).

RAHAL

(A foldable wooden stand used to hold holy scriptures (Jinvani).

PANCHMERU

(A model representing the 5 Meru mountains and their 80 eternal temples (Akrtim Jinalaya).

JAIN DHWAJA

(The official five-colored flag representing Jainism).

MANDANA

(A sacred floor design drawn for holy rituals (Vidhaan)

TEEN LOK

(A diagram showing the three worlds where all living beings reside).

SAMAVASARAN

(The grand divine assembly hall where the Lord delivers sermons).

OM

(The sacred symbol representing the five supreme holy beings (Panch Parmeshthi).

MAANSTAMBH

(The grand pillar of humility outside temples that helps visitors shed their pride)

DRAVYA DIBBI

(A small container used to carry holy offerings from home to the temple).

THONA

(A small pedestal used during ritual installations (Sthapna).

PAANI KA CHANNA

(A cloth filter used to strain water to protect microscopic life (Ahinsa).

DHOTI DUPATTA

(Clean, unstitched clothes worn while performing temple rituals).

CHATAI

(A clean mat used for sitting respectfully during prayers).

DUNDUBHI

(The celestial drum played by heavenly beings to praise the Lord)

BHAMANDAL

(The divine aura or halo behind the Lord's head showing a soul's past and future lives)

DEFILEMENTS (KASHAAY)

(1)

Upon receiving a sweet, Guddu went into a corner and began to weep.
"O Mother, my sweet is small; I shall eat only if I receive a larger one!"
While the others enjoyed their sweet, a scorpion appeared in the corner.
It stung him, causing Guddu to cry aloud, and a mouse ate away his sweet.
Guddu then took a sacred vow: "O brother, I shall never cling to obstinacy again."
From this, we all have received the wisdom:
"O brother, we must never give in to stubbornness."

(2)

Krodha is known as Anger, O brother!
Maan is what we call Pride and Vanity.
Maya is Deceitfulness and Hypocrisy,
And Lobha is termed as Greed.
These Four kashaayas are the givers of suffering;
They torment and bind the Aatam (soul).
The living beings who renounce these,
Attain eternal and infinite bliss.

(3)

A single kashaay has four children,
Which cause all beings to wander in Sansaar (the cycle of rebirth).
The first is Krodha (Anger), the second Maan (Pride),
The third Maya (Deceit), and the fourth Lobha (Greed).
When all four combine, they give rise to the affliction of worldly existence;
When all four are eradicated, one attains liberation from all disease.

(4)

A straight line signifies uprightness;
Engage in worship and meditation with pure intent.
Never harbor crooked or deceitful thoughts,
For you are the true mine of simplicity and innocence.
Venerate the Guru, meditate upon the Supreme Lord,
And do not fall into the delusion of the four realms of existence (chahu-gati).
Engage in self-contemplation (aatam-dhyaan) and proceed directly,
To the abode of liberation (Muktipuri), attaining unblemished bliss.

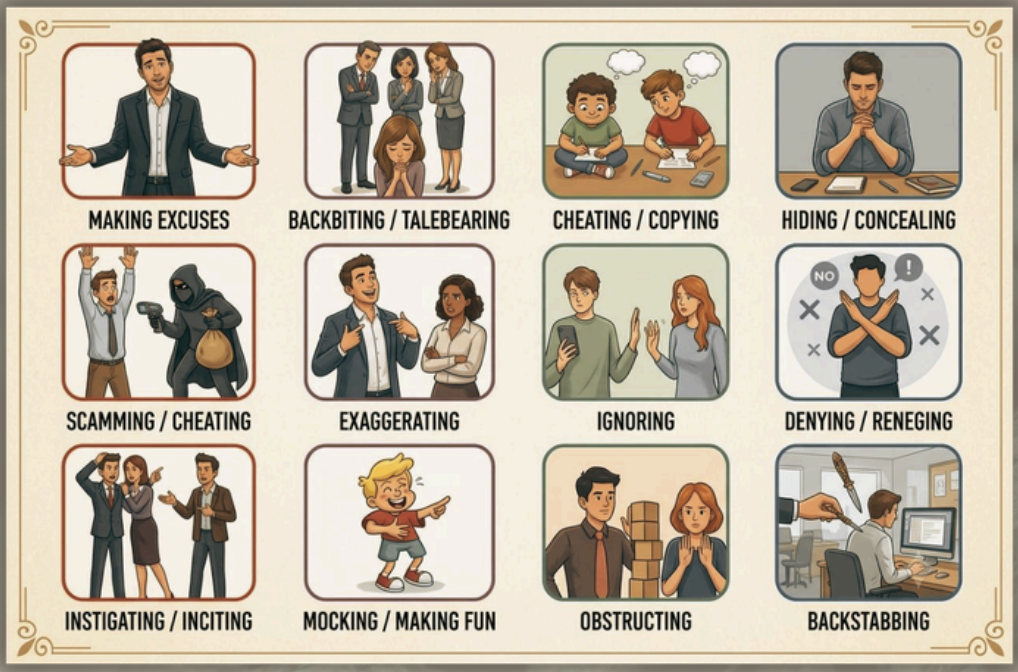
ANGER

TO KICK
TO CAUSE SADNESS
TO SCOLD
TO FIGHT
GGRRR!
!!
TO DEMONSTRATE ANGER
TO ARGUE
VANDALISM
TO PUSH
TO CRY
TO HURT ONESELF
TO ATTACK / ASSAULT
TO THREATEN / BULLEY

PRIDE

TO DEMEAN/TO HUMILIATE
TO BE PROUD OF WEALTH
TO FALL IN SOMEONE'S ESTIMATION
TO SEEK PRAISE
GGRRR!
TO BE ARROGANT OF KNOWLEDGE
TO BE VAIN ABOUT LOOKS
TO PROVOKE JEALOUSY
TO PUT ON A DISPLAY/SHOW OFF
TO SHOW OFF STRENGTH
TO WAGE WAR
TO ARGUE
TO DISOBEY

DECEITFULNESS / FRAUD



GREED

JAIN PARV (SACRED JAIN FESTIVALS)

Parv signifies a holy day—that is, a primary, special, or sacred occasion wherein the shravak (householder aspirant) seeks self-purification and ultimate self-redemption through sacred knowledge (gyaan) and righteous conduct (sadacharan), devoting the greater portion of their time to righteous contemplation (dharma dhyaan) and self-study (swadhyaya).

There are primarily three categories of Jain parvas:

1. Sadharan Parv (Ordinary Holy Days)
2. Naimittik Parv (Occasion-Based Holy Days)
3. Naisargik Parv (Eternal / Natural Holy Days)

1. SADHARAN PARV(ORDINARY HOLY DAYS)

These occur every month on days such as Ashtmi (8th day), Chaturdashi (14th day), and Panchmi (5th day). The Ashtmi, Chaturdashi, and Panchmi of each month are also referred to as Nitya Parv (regular holy observances).

2. NAIMITTIK PARV (OCCASION-BASED HOLY DAYS)

Those festivals that are celebrated in connection with the life events of Great Souls (Mahapurush) are called Naimittik Parv , such as Diwali, Mahavir Jayanti, Raksha Bandhan, and others.

i) Diwali Parv : During the final quarter of the night of Kartik Krishna Chaturdashi extending into the dawn of Amavasya, the last Tirthankar, Lord Mahavir Swami, attained Nirvan(liberation). On that very evening, Gautam Gandhar Swami attained Keval Gyaan (supreme omniscience). Hence, Diwali is reverentially observed as a holy parv .

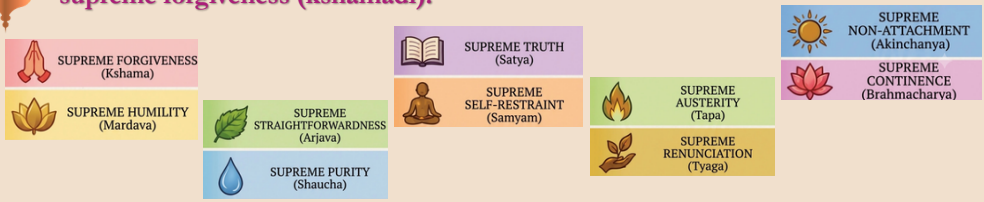
ii)Mahavir Jayanti - Mahavir Jayanti Parv is celebrated on Chaitra Shukla Teras as the auspicious birth anniversary (Janm Mahotsav) of Bhagwan Mahavir.

iii)Raksha Bandhan Parv: Raksha Bandhan Parv is observed on the full moon day (Purnima) of the month of Shraavan . On this auspicious day, Muni Vishnukumar protected 700 munis (ascetics). Once the obstacles were dispelled, the citizens rejoiced and offered pure, suitable food (Ahaar) conducive to health to the muni-sangh,as well as vaiyyavratti (devotional service). In sacred memory of this event, sisters tied a protective thread (Raksha-Sutra) around the wrists of their brothers, and since then, this holy festival became renowned throughout Bharat Varsh as Raksha Bandhan.

3. NAISARGIK PARV (ETERNAL/NATURAL HOLY DAYS)

Those holy days that are not linked to specific events in the lives of MahaPurush, but have been flowing since eternity (anadi kala), are called Naisargik Parv.
Examples include Daslakshan Parv, Shodashkaaran Parv, and Ashtanika Parv. These holy observances continue unceasingly day and night across the three spans of time—past, present, and future.

Daslakshan Parv : This sacred festival occurs thrice a year in the months of Magh-Chaitra-Bhadrapad. However, it is most commonly venerated during the month of Bhadrapad. During this festival, devout worship and adoration are offered to the ten supreme virtues (Das Dharma) of the soul, beginning with supreme forgiveness (kshamadi).



Solah Kaaran Parv : Celebrated annually, this holy festival commences on the first day of the waning moon (Krishna Pratipada) in the month of Bhadrapad and continues until the first day of the waning moon in the month of Ashvin. During this holy period, contemplative meditation is practiced upon the sixteen auspicious reflections (Shodash kaaran Bhawana). Sacred scriptures speak of these 16 reflections, through which the soul binds the revered Tirthankar prakriti. Upon the fruition of this prakriti, the divine majesty of the Asht Pratiharya (Eight Divine Attributes) is attained within the Samavasaran.

Ashtanika Parv : Occurring thrice annually from the eighth day (Shukla Ashtami) to the full moon (Purnima) in the bright fortnights of Kartik-Phalgun-Aashan, this sacred occasion is celebrated with great grandeur. During this period, the celestial beings (Devaganas) perform worship and ritual homage in the eternal, non-man-made temples (akritrim jinalayas) situated upon Nandishvar Dweep. Conscious of their own human limitations, devotees visually contemplate Nandishvar Dweep and the sacred Jina-bimbas within local Jinamandiras to offer their worship. In these holy days, devotees frequently perform the venerated Nandishvar Dweep Mandala Vidhaan worship.

During the sacred days of these festivals, one ought to sincerely observe spiritual vows (vrat), discipline (niyam), and self-restraint (sanyam). According to one's capacity, one should engage in ekasana (taking a single meal a day) or upavas (fasting), dedicating oneself to pure contemplation of the supreme Self (Atma-chintan).

PRACTICE QUESTIONS

1. What is meant by a sacred festival (Parv)?
2. How many classifications of Jain festivals are there?
3. Why and when is the sacred festival of Deepawali celebrated?
4. How many times a year does Ashtahnika Parv occur, and at what times?
5. What spiritual duties should we observe during these sacred festivals?

RELIGIOUS SLOGANS

1. Gyaata-Drashta soul, become Parmatma.

2. The intrinsic nature of substance is dharma; attachment (raag) and aversion (dwesh) are adharma.

3. The intrinsic nature of substance is dharma; know jeev and ajeev .

4. What has Jinavani bestowed? It has revealed the purest shuddhatam.

5. I am pure, awakened, and conscious; I am distinct from the modes of attachment.

6. To walk upon the path of the Guru, one must enshrine samyak charitra.

7. Where there is respect for mother and father, there is an ocean of sacred cultural values.

8. Gyaanam,Gyaanam,Gyaanam flows, coursing through every fiber of attachment and detachment.

9. Aatam, Aatam, Aatam—knowing the self, may the mind become filled with bliss.

10. Listening to Jinavani means discerning what is beneficial (hita) from what is harmful (ahita).

11. With a life entangled in root vegetables and hidden life forms , how shall one listen to the divine resonance of the Prabhu

12. If one wishes to attain righteous conduct , one must discriminate between what is allowable to consume and what is forbidden.

13. Abandon idle chatter (hii-hello), and utter the holy praise of Jai Jinendra.

14. Where there is clear discrimination between matter (jad) and consciousness (chetan), there lies the true path of liberation (mukt- maarg).

15.The three robbers of this Kaliyuga are meat, intoxicants , and tobacco.

16. By meditating upon Lord Mahavir, one attains the supreme state of Parmeshthi.

17. Sing the glory of the Tirthankaras, and enhance the honor of Jain dharma.

18. One, two, three, four—hail, hail to Jain dharma.

19. Five, six, seven, eight—recite and study the scriptures of Jain dharma.

20. Nine, ten, eleven, twelve—beat the sacred drum of Jain dharma.

21. Thirteen, fourteen, fifteen, sixteen—every child of Jain dharma speaks.

22. Seventeen, eighteen, nineteen, twenty—victory belongs to Jain dharma.

23. Twenty-one, twenty-two, twenty-three, twenty-four—the Tirthankaras of Jain dharma are twenty-four.

24. As long as the sun and moon endure, the reverence for the munis shall remain.

25. As long as water remains in the oceans, the immortal tale of the munis shall endure.

26. What has Kundakunda bestowed? He has revealed the Lord within the soul.

27. Hail to the valiant son of Trishala—shout victory to Lord Mahavir.

28. What corrupts the soul? Attachment (raag), aversion (dwesh), and false belief (mithyatv).

29. The true identity of human life is to behold Jina-darshan and realize the inner self.

30. What is the ultimate purpose of this life? To attain right faith and vision (samyak darshan).

31. From every home echoes the resonant call: Long live non-violence (ahinsa) and truth (satya).

32. The unity of the Ratnatraya (the Three Jewels) is the supreme hallmark of the path to liberation (moksh-maarg).

33. All hail to the Arihants, and to the passionless (vitrag) muni saints.

34. The beloved son of Siddharth and Trishala has blessed and fulfilled all living beings (jeevas).

35. From every home echoes the resonant call: Long live non-violence (ahinsa) and truth (satya).

NIRMOH POETRY

True happiness is found only at Your holy feet, O Bhagwan.
This is my humble prayer: May my focus remain fixed upon Your holy feet at every single moment, second by second.
May Your divine name dwell upon my tongue, and may I remember You morning and evening.
Whatever task I undertake, in every hour of the day, may my focus remain fixed upon Your holy feet. | | 1 | |
Even if I must walk upon thorns, or leave my homeland and wander,
Whether I abide in a dense forest or at home, may my focus remain fixed upon Your holy feet. | | 2 | |
Day and night I light lamps, yet why does darkness still linger within my mind?
O Lord, bestow upon me the Gyan-deep (lamp of spiritual knowledge);
may my focus remain fixed upon Your holy feet. | | 3 | |
Even if the entire world becomes my enemy, or if life strikes blows upon me,
Even if death becomes a garland around my neck,
may my focus remain fixed upon Your holy feet. | | 4 | |
Though troubles surround me, though darkness envelops me from all four sides,
May my mind never waver; may my focus remain fixed upon Your holy feet. | | 5 | |
O Lord, You are the captain across the ocean of worldly existence (Bhava-Sindhu); carry me safely to the shore beyond this realm.
Kindly accept my Aarti (devotional offering);
may my focus remain fixed upon Your holy feet. | | 6 | |

May we never forget the Panch Prabhu Bhagwan (Five Supreme Beings) in our lives.
May we always respect our elders and bow our heads in reverence to our parents.
May our actions ever be such that they bring honor to life. | | 1 | |
We shall listen to the sacred teachings of Jinvani (words of the Jina) and keep ourselves distant from sinful inclinations.
May we always walk upon the path of truth, and may Muktipuri (the abode of liberation) be our ultimate resting place. | | 2 | |
We shall seek Darshan of the Jinvar (the Conquerors) every day and remain steadfast in virtuous conduct.
May our life be imbued with truth and Ahimsa (non-violence)—may this be our ultimate glory. | | 3 | |

NIRMOH POETRY

Awakening early in the morning, may I meditate upon the sacred Namokar Mantra.
Daily, with profound reverence, I bow at the holy feet of my parents and all elders.
Adorned in pure attire, I shall journey to the Jin-mandir (temple of the Victorious Ones).
Never shall I partake of any food prior to receiving the sacred Jin-darshan (beholding the Jina).
I shall attend the pathshala to imbibe the holy teachings of Jain Dharma.
By honoring my revered teachers (gurujan), may I attain noble virtues and spiritual values.
I shall refrain from partaking of food after sunset (Ratri-bhojan) and consume only filtered water.
Having taken birth in a noble Jain lineage, I shall live strictly as a true devotee of the Jinas.
Reflecting upon the sacred words of the Jinavani, may I tread the holy path to liberation (Moksh Maarg).
Meditating upon my own true self , may I attain the supreme state of the Siddh (liberated soul).

My noble Master (Guruvar) is virtuous, my noble Master is true.
Free from the entanglements of worldly household life, unbound by earthly ties.
Ever absorbed in the bliss of the pure Soul ,my noble Master is virtuous.
Untouched by attachment and aversion, he embodies equanimity .
Committing no sin, my noble Master is virtuous.
Indeed, I shall strive to become noble as well; one day, I too shall embrace the life of a Muni (ascetic).
Abiding in my own eternal self, I too shall attain infinite bliss.

NIRMOH POETRY

I. The Path of the Devout Jaina

Jainī Jainī—devout followers of the Jina!
Jainī Jainī—yes, dear brothers.
Partaking of meals after sunset—no, dear brothers.
Consuming strained water—yes, dear brothers.
Upon beholding the Divine Presence (Jina-darshan),
joyful devotion fills the heart!

II. Overcoming Fear Through Sacred Remembrance

At night, as I lay asleep, dear mother,
An ominous sound echoed in the dark.
It felt as though a voice whispered,
"You are the next to pass."
Closing my eyes, sitting in tranquil stillness,
I contemplated the five Supreme Beings (Panch Parmeshthi).
Reciting the sacred Namokar Mantra,
I dispelled all fear from my soul.

III. Abstain from Honey

Oh, why do you consume honey?
How much demerit do you accumulate?
It is merely the secretion of bees,
Yet you mistake it for sweet nectar.
Countless bees perish in its collection,
Burned away as if in fire.
Heed this noble counsel: never partake of it.
Clap your hands in joy, for righteousness has triumphed!

NIRMOH POETRY

1) THE DISCOVERY OF THE SACRED GRANTHA

Word spread throughout the deep forest, revealing a sacred truth:
Inside a tree, a humble cowherd discovered a holy text (grantha).
There lived a simple, innocent cowherd who entered the forest,
Where he witnessed a wild fire raging all around.
Yet, one lush green tree remained untouched by the flames—
why was it not consumed?

THE GIFT KEPT SAFE

Safe within the heart of that tree lay beautifully preserved holy texts (granthas).
Filled with deep joy, he bore them gently back to his village.
Though unlettered, his heart pondered: why was he unable to read
these sacred words?

THE BIRTH OF ACHARYA KUNDKUND

Through immense spiritual fortune , a revered Muniraj arrived one day.
With profound devotion , the cowherd offered the scriptures (Shastra daan),
filling his consciousness with holy bliss.
Through the virtue of that immaculate devotion,
that very cowherd was reborn as the venerable Muni Kundkund.

2) REFLECTION ON PURITY OF FOOD (ACHAR & ILLI)

Father went to the market and brought back pickles (achar).
Inside the pickle, a caterpillar (illi) was seen, while the cat laughed merrily.
Mother sings a gentle reminder: never partake of fermented or contaminated food (achar).

3) THE OBSERVANCE OF RATRI-BHOJAN TYAAG (AVOIDANCE OF NIGHT EATING)

A wedding procession arrived in a village as seven struck in the evening.
Jains and non-Jains gathered together, inviting everyone to partake in the evening meal.
As food was being cooked in the dark of night, a venomous serpent
fell into the vegetables.
The Jain followers do not partake of food after sunset (Ratri-Bhojan),
while non-Jains teased them playfully:
"Will these people attain heaven (dwarf) merely by letting their bodies wither away?"
Yet as the others sat down to eat,
they were struck with a sudden ailment of unconsciousness.
They were rushed to the hospital,
while the compassionate Jains dutifully performed their selfless service.
Indeed, we shall renounce eating at night , and become true practitioners of the Jain path.

NIRMOH POETRY

MY HOME

I possess a beautiful home,
A home full of sweetness and peace.
Within it resides a sacred shrine dedicated to Jinvani .
Upon its roof flutters the five-colored Jina flag.
Holding a sacred water pot (kalash), I stand in humble waiting,
Eager to perform Padhghahan for the revered ascetic.
With the utmost devotion of navdha -bhakti,
I shall humbly offer ahaar to the munivara.

THE JOURNEY TO LIBERATION

We shall visit our grandmother's abode,
Where simple sweetmeats and treats shall be shared.
When we come across a vast river,
Together we shall build a boat.
We shall board it and cross over,
And swiftly attain the supreme realm of Moksh.

WISDOM AND ABSTINENCE

Beholding a potato paratha, the bear's mind was tempted with craving:
"I shall partake in this feast and grow sturdy and big."
The gentle child then spoke to the bear: "O innocent bear,
You lack true wisdom; you remain steeped in ignorance.
Because you consume root vegetables like potatoes,
you have reaped this earthly incarnation.
Do you not desire to reach the ultimate bliss of Moksh?
Must you remain forever in the Triyanch gati?
As for me, I shall ascend to Moksh,
and I abstain from root vegetables forever."

FROM CLOCK TO CONTEMPLATION – FROM CLOCK TO ROSARY

In the sacred tradition of Jainism, a mala comprises 111 beads, a count deeply rooted in spiritual significance and philosophical truth.
By chanting upon the 108 beads,
a saadhak may attain guidance along the path to moksh .The 3 additional beads in the mala represent the Ratnatraya (Three Jewels):

(1) Samyak Darshan (Right Faith)
(2) Samyak Gyaan (Right Knowledge)
(3) Samyak Charitra (Right Conduct)

Together, all these beads offer gentle guidance to the seeker upon their sacred spiritual journey.

In this depiction, Samyak Darshan, Samyak Gyaan, and Samyak Charitra serve as the 3 hands of a clock. Surrounding them are 12 petals, each inscribed 9 times with the sacred syllable OM enabling the seeker to complete 12 X 9 = 108 recitations. Reciting the mala through this contemplative design minimizes the likelihood of error.

No.	Name of Tirthankar	Complexion	Mother	Father	Birthplace	Sacred Tree
1	Adinath Ji	GOLDEN	Marudevi	Nabhiraay	Ayodhya	Banyan
2	Ajitnat Ji	GOLDEN	Vijayadevi	Jitashatru	Ayodhya	Devil
3	Sambhavnath Ji	GOLDEN	Susena	Jitari	Shravasti	Silk cotton
4	Abhinandan Ji	GOLDEN	Siddhartha	Sanwar	Ayodhya	Indian kino
5	Sumatinath Ji	GOLDEN	Mangala	Meghprabh	Ayodhya	Beautyberry
6	Padmaprabhu Ji	RED	Susima	Dharanraj	Kaushambi	Beautyberry
7	Suparshvanath Ji	GREEN	Prithvi	Supratishtha	Banaras	Siris
8	Chandraprabhu Ji	WHITE	Laxman	Mahasen	Chandrapuri	Ironwood
9	Pushpdant Ji	WHITE	Rama	Sugriv	Kakandi	Ironwood
10	Sheetalnath Ji	GOLDEN	Sunanda	Dranrathraj	Bhaddilpur	Bael
11	Shreyanshnath Ji	GOLDEN	Venudevi	Vishnu Narendra	Sinhpuri	Coromandel Ebony
12	Vasupujya Ji	RED	Jaya	Vasupujy	Champapuri	Kadamba
13	Vimalnath Ji	GOLDEN	Shyama	Kratvarman	Kampila	Black plum
14	Anantnath Ji	GOLDEN	Suyasha	Singhsen	Ayodhya	Sacred fig
15	Dharmanath Ji	GOLDEN	Suvrata	Bhanuraja	Ratnapuri	Devil
16	Shantinath Ji	GOLDEN	Achiradevi	Vishwasen	Hastinapur	Pinwheel flower
17	Kunthunath Ji	GOLDEN	Shridevi	Surya	Hastinapur	Tilaka
18	Aranath Ji	GOLDEN	Devirani	Sudarshan	Hastinapur	Mango
19	Mallinath Ji	GOLDEN	Rakshita	Kumbha	Mithila	Ashoka
20	Munisuvratnath Ji	Black	Padmavati	Sumitra	Rajgrahi	Golden champa
21	Naminath Ji	Golden	Vapra	Vijay	Mithila	Maulsari
22	Neminath Ji	Black	Shivdevi	Samudravijay	Shauripur	Bamboo
23	Parshvanath Ji	GREEN	Vama	Ashwasen	Banaras	Deodar cedar
24	Mahavir Ji	Golden	Trishala	Siddharth	Kundalpur	Sal

No.	Name of Tirthankar	Lifespan	Height	Vairagya	Moksh
1	Adinath Ji	84 lakh purva	500 dhanush	Demise of Nilanjana	Kailash Parvat
2	Ajitnat Ji	72 lakh purva	450 dhanush	Witnessing a strike of lightning	Sammed Shikharji
3	Sambhavnath Ji	60 lakh purva	400 dhanush	Observing gathering clouds	Sammed Shikharji
4	Abhinandan Ji	50 lakh purva	350 dhanush	Dissolution of clouds	Sammed Shikharji
5	Sumatinath Ji	40 lakh purva	300 dhanush	Awakening of Past life memories	Sammed Shikharji
6	Padmaprabhu Ji	30 lakh purva	250 dhanush	Awakening of Past life memories	Sammed Shikharji
7	Suparshvanath Ji	20 lakh purva	200 dhanush	Awakening of Past life memories	Sammed Shikharji
8	Chandraprabhu Ji	10 lakh purva	150 dhanush	Looking into a mirror	Sammed Shikharji
9	Pushpdant Ji	2 lakh purva	100 dhanush	Sighting a falling meteor	Sammed Shikharji
10	Sheetalnath Ji	1 lakh purva	90 dhanush	Evaporation of a dewdrop	Sammed Shikharji
11	Shreyanshnath Ji	84 lakh yrs.	80 dhanush	Falling of autumn leaves	Sammed Shikharji
12	Vasupujya Ji	72 lakh yrs.	70 dhanush	Awakening of Past life memories	Champapuri
13	Vimalnath Ji	60 lakh yrs.	60 dhanush	Evaporation of dew	Sammed Shikharji
14	Anantnath Ji	30 lakh yrs.	50 dhanush	Sighting a falling meteor	Sammed Shikharji
15	Dharmanath Ji	10 lakh yrs.	45 dhanush	Sighting a falling meteor	Sammed Shikharji
16	Shantinath Ji	1 lakh yrs.	40 dhanush	Reflecting in a mirror	Sammed Shikharji
17	Kunthunath Ji	95,000 yrs.	35 dhanush	Awakening of Past life memories	Sammed Shikharji
18	Aranath Ji	84,000 yrs.	30 dhanush	Scattering of clouds	Sammed Shikharji
19	Mallinath Ji	55,000 yrs.	25 dhanush	Lightning strike	Sammed Shikharji
20	Munisuvratnath Ji	30,000 yrs.	20 dhanush	Awakening of Past life memories	Sammed Shikharji
21	Naminath Ji	10,000 yrs.	15 dhanush	Awakening of Past life memories	Sammed Shikharji
22	Neminath Ji	1,000 yrs.	10 dhanush	Hearing the cries of bound animals	Girnar Parvat
23	Parshvanath Ji	100 yrs.	9 cubits	Awakening of Past life memories	Sammed Shikharji
24	Mahavir Ji	72 yrs.	7 cubits	Awakening of Past life memories	Pawapuri

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